

Microsoft Build 2021 Highlights

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icrosoft held its annual developer conference Build in a digital version this year.

Build 2021 saw several key announcements made by Microsoft CEO Satya Nadella during his keynote including massive changes to Windows 10 in terms of features and a UX overhaul. Codenamed Sun Valley, the new build of Windows 10 is likely to be revealed with the platform's Fall Update.

With ARM SoCs getting popular by the year, Microsoft has also set its eyes on the ARM ecosystem. It announced increased support and would be releasing a Dev Box for developers to start working towards refactoring their codebase for ARM. The developer boxes will be shipping out soon and will also be available



on the Microsoft Store this summer.

The next major update was focused on Teams and Outlook. With more than 145 million daily users, Teams is a massive collaboration platform which will receive a new category of cross-device collaborative applications. Microsoft will also allow third-party apps to access

real-time audio and video streams for note-taking and transcription generation services. Outlook, on the other hand, will get better integrated with Teams making the experience more fluid and seamless.

Next up was Microsoft's Edge browser based on Chromium. Starting from version 91, the browser will include new features such as Sleeping Tabs and Startup Boost.

On the cloud front, Azure received several updates to its Azure AI services including Azure Bot Service, Metrics Advisor, Video Analyzer, Cognitive Search, Form Recognizer and Immersive Reader. All of these features will be combined under the new Azure AI category of services. A large portion of the keynote was dedicated to reiterating that the Azure platform would emphasize trust by design.

FBI thwarts plan to kill 70 per cent of the Internet

The go-to website for software engineers to resolve their coding bugs, queries and to generally steal code from – Stack Overflow – has been sold for USD 1.8 Billion. Tech giant Prosus acquired the platform in what is being termed as its largest purchase ever. Prosus, based in Amsterdam is the largest shareholder in Chinese internet and video gaming company Tencent Holdings Ltd. Stack Overflow isn't the first acquisition for Prosus in the edutech space as the company already owns Udemy and Codecademy, two massive online learning platforms.



Stack Overflow is a free-to-use question and answer service that covers a wide variety of technical and non-technical domains. It also offers a subscription-based SaaS model of the platform that can be hosted as a private version for small and large teams to collaborate on. And it also features integration

with popular tools such as GitHub. About 85 per cent of the businesses that use this particular premium service are based in the U.S. Prosus stated that it aims to expand the service geographically to developing markets like India.



*Technical writing courses

Jump on the Technical Writing bandwagon with new courses by Google aimed at helping developers improve their documentation skills.
<http://dgit.in/techwriting>



*Doom Captcha

A developer has made solving CAPTCHAs fun by building a simple DOOM level around one. It comes with a cheat code too.
<http://dgit.in/DOOMcaptcha>



*Sublime Text 4 released

Sublime Text 4 has finally released a stable version bringing support for Apple Silicon, Linux ARM64 and GPU rendering for its brand new UI.
<http://dgit.in/subtext4>